

PRADHAN MANTRI ANUSUCHIT JAATI ABHYUDAY YOJANA (PM-AJAY) GUIDELINES 2024-25

Section 1: Scheme Overview & Objectives

PM-AJAY aims to reduce poverty of Scheduled Caste (SC) communities through skill development, infrastructure creation, and direct financial assistance for income-generating micro-enterprises.

Section 2: Grant-in-Aid (GIA) Component & Micro-Enterprise Equipment

Under Section 4.2 (GIA Micro-Enterprises), financial assistance up to Rs. 50,000 per beneficiary is provided directly for purchasing self-employment tools and machinery.

- Micro-Enterprise Equipment Grant: Covers motorized sewing machines, tailoring toolkits, artisan kits, and small equipment.
- Eligibility: SC households with annual family income below Rs. 2.50 Lakh, possessing basic vocational aptitude.

Section 3: Skill Development & RPL (Recognition of Prior Learning)

Skill training is implemented through ITIs, PMKKs, and NSDC training centers aligned with the National Skills Qualifications Framework (NSQF).

- RPL (Recognition of Prior Learning): Informal workers with pre-existing skills (e.g. self-taught tailors, uncertified mechanics) are assessed directly for NSQF certification within 3 to 5 days without full course requirements.
- Stipend & Certification: Beneficiaries undergoing RPL receive an official NSQF Certificate and digital skill badge.

Section 4: Infrastructure & Skill Center Assistance

Grants are allocated for setting up Common Facility Centers (CFCs), District Skill Labs, and Tool Rooms to support rural artisans.